MODULE 09 · DOMAIN 2 - OUTPUT EVALUATION AND VALIDATION

When a Human Must Review

What raises the stakes, how to decide whether to escalate, and how to make human review meaningful rather than a rubber stamp.

DOMAIN 2 of 7 EXAM WEIGHT 21% MODULE 9 of 33

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Claude can draft almost anything.
Someone still has to answer for it.

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What raises the stakes

- **An external audience:** clients, investors, regulators, the public.
- **Commitments:** prices, service levels, legal terms, promises.
- **Decisions about people:** jobs, pay, credit, discipline, health.
- **Hard to undo:** once sent, signed or published, it is out.
- **Regulated or sensitive content**, or a topic new to the organisation.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> The more of these an output has, the stronger the case for review or escalation before use.

Light check, or proper review?

YOUR OWN CHECK IS ENOUGH

Low stakes

- Internal and informal
- No commitments made
- Nobody's rights affected
- Easy to correct later

REVIEW OR ESCALATE FIRST

High stakes

- Goes to a client or regulator
- Commits the organisation
- Affects a person's job or money
- Cannot be pulled back

THE TIEBREAKER

Review is proportionate to impact. Not everything needs escalating, and some things always do.

The escalation decision, in order

01

Audience and impact

Who sees it, and what if it is wrong?

02

Assess the risk

Errors found, sensitivity, confidence.

03

Compare with criteria

The organisation's escalation rules.

04

Decide

Use, iterate or escalate.

05

Record

The decision and the reason.

ON THE EXAM

Start with audience and impact. Finish by recording the decision and why.

Human in the loop is a design, not an afterthought

- **Decide where review sits** before the workflow runs, not after something goes wrong.
- **Name who reviews:** someone qualified, with authority to change the output.
- **Say what they check:** a short list, matched to the risk.
- **Review before it reaches the person affected**, not as a monthly sample afterwards.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> A reviewer who cannot change the output, or sees it too late, is not a control.

Proportionate review

OUTPUT	REVIEW IT NEEDS
Internal notes, ideas, first drafts	The author's own check
Internal decision paper	A peer or manager reviews it
Client-facing, or makes commitments	The accountable owner approves it
Decisions about a person's job, money or rights	A qualified person decides; Claude only assists

ON THE EXAM

Match the depth of review to the impact of being wrong.

Anthropic's rule for high-risk uses

- **Human review:** a qualified person meaningfully reviews the AI's recommendation before it reaches the individual, with authority to change it.
- **Disclosure:** people affected are told that AI was used.
- **Areas named include** legal, medical, finance, credit, insurance, housing, employment and education.
- **Updated policy effective 12 Nov 2026.** These two core requirements are unchanged from the previous version.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> In high-risk areas, review and disclosure are policy requirements, not good-practice extras.

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Review, or rubber stamp?

RUBBER STAMP

Approve, approve, approve

- Seconds per item
- Nothing ever changed
- No list of what to check
- Trusts the draft because it is fluent

MEANINGFUL REVIEW

Checked against a list

- Time matched to the risk
- Changes are made and tracked
- A short checklist per output type
- Reviewer accountable for sign-off

THE TIEBREAKER

A review that never changes anything is not a review.

"Claude writes the client emails now, so we can stop checking them"

- **Acknowledge the gain.** Drafting time really has fallen.
- **Explain the risk:** client emails carry commitments, and Claude can be confidently wrong.
- **Propose proportion:** a light check for routine replies, full review for commitments and complaints.
- **Measure it:** track what reviewers change, and adjust the level of review with evidence.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Neither "no review" nor "review everything forever": proportionate review, adjusted by evidence.

Escalating well

- **To the right person:** the owner of the risk, such as legal, finance, data protection or the AI review group.
- **With what they need:** the output, what you found, why it matters, and the specific question.
- **Hold the risky part**, not necessarily everything, until it is resolved.
- **Not by reflex.** Escalating everything buries the escalations that matter.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> A good escalation asks a specific question of the person who owns the risk.

> Four Claude-drafted outputs are waiting in Halden's customer success queue.
>
> The team lead can only send one for full review before the end of the day.

Which most strongly calls for review before use?

A. An unedited reply to a paying client that commits Halden to a two-hour emergency response

B. A summary of this morning's internal team meeting

C. A list of possible themes for the staff summer event

D. A draft note that mixes British and American spelling

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which most strongly calls for review before use?

A An unedited reply to a paying client that commits Halden to a two-hour emergency response

External, unedited, and a service commitment Halden must honour.

B A summary of this morning's internal team meeting

Internal and easy to correct.

C A list of possible themes for the staff summer event

Internal ideas. No commitment, no harm if wrong.

D A draft note that mixes British and American spelling

A cosmetic fault, not a risk.

THE SIGNAL

Paying client, unedited, and a service commitment: three stakes-raisers at once.

> Halden HR wants Claude to draft responses to formal grievances raised by staff. Each response states the outcome and what happens next.
>
> HR asks where human review should sit in this workflow.

Which design is most appropriate?

A. Send responses straight away, and sample a few each month for quality

B. No review, because Claude's drafts are always polite and careful

C. A qualified HR partner reviews, and can change, every response before it reaches the employee

D. Ask each employee to flag any response they think is wrong

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which design is most appropriate?

A. Send responses straight away, and sample a few each month for quality

Review after harm is done. The employee already has the outcome.

B. No review, because Claude's drafts are always polite and careful

Politeness is not correctness. Employment outcomes need accountability.

C. A qualified HR partner reviews, and can change, every response before it reaches the employee

Qualified, empowered, and before it reaches the person affected.

D. Ask each employee to flag any response they think is wrong

Shifts the organisation's responsibility onto the person affected.

THE SIGNAL

An employment outcome reaching an individual: qualified review with authority, before delivery.

> Halden's finance team plans to use Claude to recommend whether staff who apply for a hardship loan should receive one, and how much.
>
> The recommendation will go to the employee as the outcome of their application.

Under Anthropic's Usage Policy, which two requirements apply? Choose two.

A Claude must make the final decision, so outcomes are consistent

B A qualified person must meaningfully review each recommendation before it reaches the employee

C No disclosure is needed, because the scheme is internal to Halden

D Employees affected must be told that AI was used

E Each recommendation must be kept very short

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Under Anthropic's Usage Policy, which two requirements apply? Choose two.

A Claude must make the final decision, so outcomes are consistent

The opposite of the rule. A person must review, with authority to change.

B A qualified person must meaningfully review each recommendation before it reaches the employee

The human-review requirement for high-risk uses.

C No disclosure is needed, because the scheme is internal to Halden

Internal or not, it reaches an individual and affects their finances.

D Employees affected must be told that AI was used

The disclosure requirement for high-risk uses.

E Each recommendation must be kept very short

Not a policy requirement.

THE SIGNAL

A finance decision reaching an individual is high risk: human review and disclosure.

A Halden account manager has a Claude-drafted letter to a client in a dispute over missed visits. The letter proposes a settlement.

She must decide whether the letter needs escalating before it is sent.

Which step should she take first?

A Identify who will read the letter, and the impact if it is wrong

B Record her decision and the reasons for it

C Decide whether to send, revise or escalate the letter

D Compare the letter's risk with Halden's escalation criteria

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which step should she take first?

A Identify who will read the letter, and the impact if it is wrong

Frames the stakes. Every later step depends on it.

B Record her decision and the reasons for it

The last step, after a decision exists.

C Decide whether to send, revise or escalate the letter

The decision comes after the assessment.

D Compare the letter's risk with Halden's escalation criteria

Needs the risk assessed first, which needs the impact known.

THE SIGNAL

Escalation decisions open with audience and impact, and close with a record.

> Site supervisors approve Claude-drafted incident reports before they go to clients. An audit finds almost every report approved unchanged within seconds.
>
> Two approved reports contained the wrong incident date.

What is the best fix?

A. Remove the approval step, since it adds no value

B. Switch to a more capable model so dates are always right

C. Require two supervisors to click approve on each report

D. Give reviewers a short checklist of what to verify, time to do it, and track what they change

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the best fix?

A Remove the approval step, since it adds no value

Removes the only chance to catch errors that reach clients.

B Switch to a more capable model so dates are always right

No model guarantees correctness. Review still matters.

C Require two supervisors to click approve on each report

Two rubber stamps are still rubber stamps.

D Give reviewers a short checklist of what to verify, time to do it, and track what they change

Turns a rubber stamp into a meaningful review.

THE SIGNAL

Approved in seconds, nothing ever changed, errors through: the review is a rubber stamp.

> Halden's chief operating officer tells the customer success team that Claude-drafted client emails can now go out without anyone checking them.
>
> Many of those emails confirm visit times, prices and responses to complaints.

What is the most appropriate response?

A Agree, to keep a senior sponsor of the project on side

B Acknowledge the time saved, explain the risks, and propose review matched to each type of email

C Stop using Claude for client emails altogether

D Keep checking every email quietly, without raising it

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the most appropriate response?

A Agree, to keep a senior sponsor of the project on side

Trades client risk for internal comfort.

B Acknowledge the time saved, explain the risks, and propose review matched to each type of email

Honest, constructive and proportionate.

C Stop using Claude for client emails altogether

Throws away real gains instead of managing the risk.

D Keep checking every email quietly, without raising it

Avoids the conversation, and the policy stays wrong.

THE SIGNAL

Emails confirming times, prices and complaint outcomes still carry commitments.

> Four Claude-drafted items are ready in a Halden manager's folder.
>
> She wants to know which one can go ahead with only her own check, and no escalation.

Which item can proceed with the author's own check?

A. A list of agenda ideas for her team's planning away day

B. A letter to a client confirming revised contract prices

C. A response to a regulator's request for information

D. A message telling an employee the outcome of a disciplinary hearing

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which item can proceed with the author's own check?

A A list of agenda ideas for her team's planning away day

Internal, no commitments, easily changed.

B A letter to a client confirming revised contract prices

External and commits Halden to prices.

C A response to a regulator's request for information

Regulatory, external and potentially binding.

D A message telling an employee the outcome of a disciplinary hearing

An employment decision about a person.

THE SIGNAL

Proportion works both ways: low-stakes work does not need escalating.

A tender requires bidders to state their insurance cover. Claude's draft answer gives specific cover limits for Halden, and the bid writer cannot find where they came from.

The tender response will be legally binding if Halden wins.

What should the bid writer do?

A Delete the insurance statement and submit without it

B Keep it, since Claude probably found the figures in the documents

C Ask Claude to reword the statement more cautiously

D Send the statement and her question to the insurance owner in finance, and hold that answer until confirmed

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the bid writer do?

A Delete the insurance statement and submit without it

The tender requires it. Omitting it fails compliance.

B Keep it, since Claude probably found the figures in the documents

"Probably" is not good enough for a binding statement.

C Ask Claude to reword the statement more cautiously

Rewording an unverified figure does not verify it.

D Send the statement and her question to the insurance owner in finance, and hold that answer until confirmed

The right owner, a specific question, and only the risky part held.

THE SIGNAL

Required, binding and unverifiable by her: escalate to the risk owner with a specific question.

In five lines

- **Stakes rise** with external audiences, commitments, decisions about people and things you cannot undo.
- **Escalation sequence:** audience and impact, assess risk, compare criteria, decide, record.
- **Design review in:** qualified, empowered, before it reaches the person affected.
- **Anthropic's high-risk rule:** meaningful human review, and disclosure that AI was used.
- **Proportion both ways:** no rubber stamps, and no escalating everything.

COMING UP

Next: refining outputs for their audience, and choosing the right format.